Framing Electoral Credibility on X: Public Discourse on Real-Time Result Transmission Ahead of Nigeria's 2027 General Elections

Godlyn Chidiadi Abisoye, Ph.D. Adesegun Samson Adetola

Abstract

As the 2027 general elections in Nigeria approaches, real-time result transmission has become an important battleground for negotiating, building, and challenging electoral credibility. This study analyses how X becomes a platform where electoral transparency, trust, reform, and suspicion are discussed long before votes are cast. In addition to being seen as a legal and technological practice, the discussion of result transmission is also regarded as a political communication practice that emerges from elite framing, platform logic, news dissemination, and public response. Through a qualitative textual analysis of posts and reply threads shared by electoral agencies, political parties, civil society organisations, journalists, and influential individuals, this study uncovers the main frames in pre-election discussions on X. Rather than being an attempt to comment on the policies being discussed, the online debate on the issue actually becomes a source for setting public expectations regarding the integrity of the 2027 polls. Thus, this research contributes to the existing body of literature on platforms and political communication in Nigeria by analysing how electoral credibility is framed, amplified, and challenged through X. It becomes clear, then, that digital framing has become one of the most important preconditions for whether electoral results are going to be accepted, rejected, or contested in Nigeria.

Keywords: Electoral credibility, Result transmission, 2027 general elections, Nigeria, Political communication, X

Introduction

The 2027 general elections in Nigeria are currently taking shape during the pre-election phase. Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC) has released a new schedule for conducting presidential and National Assembly elections on 16 January 2027 and governorship and State Assembly elections on 6 February 2027. Along with these early arrangements, there is ongoing discussion about real-time electronic result transmission, which has emerged as a major credibility issue in the election process. Reuters reported in February 2026 that the Nigerian Senate approved the real-time transmission of results despite reservations from some members about insecurity and unequal internet access. Such trends suggest that the credibility of elections is being challenged before the election process, not just afterward (INEC, 2026; Reuters, 2026).

Election credibility relies not only on regulations and procedures, but also on how they are framed and explained to the public. Ajaegbu and Ajaegbu (2024) found that social media has become a norm for political participation in Sub-Saharan Africa, while Fisher et al. (2024) noted that, in West Africa, digital media is now integral to political communication and party messaging. Therefore, debates about election procedures on social media are part of that process and shape how citizens view transparency and institutional effectiveness. The platform is examined not so much as a means of transmission as a place where legitimacy and visibility are mediated. As Naranjo-Vinueza et al. (2025) note, the dynamic nature of X influences how political communication on the platform constructs notions of authority and public meaning. This relates to the Nigerian example, where real-time result transmission is seen not only as an improvement in administrative processes but also as a way to verify and test the election process itself.

Research suggests that political discourse can undermine electoral trust before voting begins at polling units (Sinclair et al. (2018). Negative campaigns especially reduce trust where confidence in institutions is already

lacking (Amakoh, 2025). This is relevant because debate about result transmission occurs in an environment already fraught with trust and legitimacy issues. While most discussions focus on administrative and legal aspects, less attention is given to discussions regarding electronic transmission of results on X. This study investigates how posts and comments have framed the transmission of results as a symbol of transparency and legitimacy ahead of the 2027 elections. This study addresses this gap by analysing discourse on X about the transmission of results before Nigeria's 2027 general elections, treating it as a communicative practice that shapes perceptions of electoral credibility. Two main objectives guide the study:

To examine how selected posts and reply threads on X frame real-time result transmission ahead of Nigeria's 2027 general election; and

Analyse how these frames shape public understanding of electoral credibility, transparency, and trust in the pre-election period.

Platforms and the Public Construction of Electoral Credibility

Political communication research has evolved from merely studying digital media as channels for disseminating messages to recognising their role as spaces where platform-specific mechanisms create legitimacy, visibility, and power. As Naranjo-Vinueza et al. (2025) note, X has become a platform that puts political visibility and public authority at stake. This aspect is critical to this research, as a discussion of technical or administrative matters can swiftly become a symbolic battle over trust in institutions once taken up on X. This means the meaning of regulations is determined not solely by the regulations themselves but also by how they are framed.

Research suggests that electoral trust is sensitive to the overall communication context. According to Amakoh (2025), negative media reporting adversely affects electoral trust in contexts where institutional trust is weak. Similarly, Mauk and Grömping (2024) observe that online misinformation reduces accuracy and polarises beliefs about election fairness, whereas Cohen et al. (2024) note that electoral trust is contextual and depends on citizens' interpretations of elections. Overall, this research implies that procedures are not sufficient for credibility, but that credibility is constructed publicly through communication, interpretation, and exposure to rival claims. Therefore, in the present research, it is essential to view the debate over the real-time transmission of results on X as an integral part of the credibility process.

Social Media and Election Communication in Africa

The debate around the role of social media in African elections research is no longer largely centered on whether social media is important. What is more crucial is the discussion of its relevance within particular political and media systems. According to Abboud et al. (2024), in their research on the 2022 presidential election, the influence of social media on politics is contingent on interactions among platforms, conventional media, and politics. This is relevant because it does not treat social media as an entity in its own right.

Research conducted in recent years on Africa suggests the same. According to Ajaegbu and Ajaegbu (2024), social media is now an everyday tool for political participation and discourse throughout sub-Saharan Africa. Fisher et al. (2024) illustrate how WhatsApp plays a pivotal role in the organisation and control of messages by the parties in Ghana and Nigeria. News and political conversations motivate people to participate actively in 30 African countries. Yet, the correlation is contingent on context (Adegbola & O'Neil, 2025). For instance, Omoniyi (2026) illustrates that the voter education programme run by INEC in Ondo City, Nigeria, was neither fully inclusive nor timely. The evidence above suggests that both social media and civic communication, whether effective or ineffective, can influence the pre-election information environment. That is why social media discussions of electoral procedures within the framework of the 2027 Nigerian elections are especially vital

Electoral Credibility and the Pre-Election Information Environment

Electoral credibility would also need to address the disinformation problems that have characterised pre-election discourses. According to Hassan (2023), disinformation is a major element of political and electoral discourse in Nigeria, especially on social media platforms. Omilusi (2025) noted how election disinformation in Africa undermines not only the electoral process but also democratic values and people's rights. The significance of these studies is that they demonstrate that public discourse on transparency does not occur in a neatly organised information environment.

The recent studies from Nigeria support this notion. As shown by Okorie and Olagunju (2025), Lagos social media users encounter false information despite their high level of fact-checking knowledge. Additionally, Schwemmer and Riedl (2025) show how political influencers can sway elections by establishing specific structures of visibility and influence within networked environments. As shown by Uwalaka et al. (2025), secret influencer communities or "Data Boys" can be leveraged to advance and restore the reputations of political actors on social media, maintaining the façade of authenticity. In other words, these studies suggest that pre-election discussions on X encompass both sincere debate and organised efforts.

Theoretical Framework

This research is based on the Framing Theory. Entman (1993) offered one of the best formulations of this framework, arguing that framing is a process of highlighting selected aspects of reality and making them more visible in a communicative text to diagnose problems and their causes, make moral judgments, and offer solutions. . In other words, public matters do not simply get into communication spaces, they get there after being chosen and highlighted in a particular way. It is also helpful because it connects media texts to public interpretation. As Scheufele (1999) states, framing is a process in which communicators create frames, audiences accept them, and public interpretations are formed. In the context of an upcoming election, this implies that rival posts, comments, and discussions on X will not only reflect public opinion but also help shape the interpretation of the election's credibility. Therefore, a discussion on the transmission of results can be framed as a technical necessity, an impossible expectation, an indication of weak institutions, or a means of protecting people from rigging.

According to de Vreese (2005), framing should be seen as an aspect of media production and of its effects on audience interpretation of messages. Chong and Druckman (2007) reinforce this framework by arguing that framing is important because people respond differently depending on which aspects are emphasised in the communication process. This is important to this study since X is not just a platform for communicating in the official language. It is also a place for responses by journalists, activists, political allies, opponents, and regular users to interpretations of events. This means that the transmission of results will not be decided by formal policy discourse alone. In most cases, public trust in elections depends on the first emphasis that attracts people's attention. For instance, if the dominant frame is about transparency, then the transmission of the results can be seen as an improvement in credibility. On the other hand, if the dominant frame is on technical problems or security issues, the same process can raise doubts among citizens.

In a nutshell, this framework works well for the study in two respects. First, it provides an ideal platform for identifying the patterns that define real-time discussions about result transmission on X. Second, it helps explain how these patterns can shape public perceptions of the credibility, transparency, and trustworthiness of the 2027 general election. This theory works well for the research because it enables the researcher to shift from describing patterns of result transmission to interpreting them.

Methodology

This research uses a qualitative textual methodology to examine the meanings constructed in selected

messages and reply threads on X about the real-time transmission of results before the Nigerian general elections of 2027. This qualitative methodology is appropriate because it explores debates and discussions about the credibility of the election in an increasingly rapid digital environment. Qualitative methodology is appropriate for exploring topics in which language, context, and the meanings of communication conveyed by the text are essential (Creswell & Poth, 2018; Tracy, 2010).

Purposive sampling identifies relevant messages and reply chains from publicly available messages related to the research objectives. Messages are included in the analysis if they directly discuss the transmission of election results, electronic result transmission, or similar topics related to the 2027 election in Nigeria. To explore different perspectives on the topic, the sample of messages is collected from categories of actors, including institutional actor (INEC), political actors (Atiku Abubakar, Peter Obi, Yunusa Tanko/Obidient Movement, Official PDP, Nasiru Ahmad El-Rufai), civic actors (EiE Nigeria, Nigeria Civil Society Situation Room), and media institutions (ARISE News, TheCable, The Sun. and THISDAY), were selected because they directly addressed real-time result transmission, electronic result transmission, IReV, BVAS, manual backup, statutory backing or related electoral credibility debates and because such actors occupy visible positions in Nigeria's pre-election information environment. The corpus comprised 14 original public posts and seven selected replies on X between January and May 2026. This period was selected because it captured the emergence and continuation of the public debate central to this study

The selection was also guided by public accessibility, traceability through post URLs, actor diversity, and clear framing relevance to transparency, institutional sincerity, technical feasibility, electoral preparedness, or public trust. Ethically, ordinary users were included only through selected replies that substantively accepted, extended, questioned or challenged the frames in the original posts. However, they were anonymised because they participated as private individuals rather than as official or organisational actors. This aligns with internet-mediated research ethics on participant confidentiality and identifiability, which recommend contextual ethical judgement and the careful handling of identifiable online data, even when such data are publicly available (Kaye et al., 2021; frannzke et al., 2020). Additionally, because political debate on social media can contain sensitive language, particularly in the context of pre-election.

The original posts and replies were selected purposively because the study sought information-rich texts that could illuminate how real-time result transmission was framed and contested within selected X discourse. This aligns with qualitative framing approaches that support analysis of purposively selected, meaningful, and manageable online-media samples rather than statistically representative datasets (Wachinger et al., 2025). The reply-thread sample was used as supplementary evidence of audience engagement with the frames identified in the original posts; it was not intended as a representative sample of all responses to the 14 posts, nor as a matched reply for every post. Replies were included only where they made substantive contributions by accepting, extending, questioning, or challenging the frames under analysis. This use of replies aligns with conversational framing research on X, which shows that replies can extend, challenge, or reframe meanings introduced in original posts (Zade et al., 2024). The six replies should therefore be read as information-rich examples within the selected X discourse, consistent with the qualitative framing purpose of examining how meanings were constructed and contested rather than measuring the volume or representativeness of responses across the platform.

Framing forms the foundation of thematic coding. The first step involves rereading the selected texts to identify patterns in framing and evaluation of real-time result transmission. This step focuses on problem identification, causal explanation, evaluation, and proposed solutions, following the structure of frame analysis (Entman, 1993). The second step involves organising the identified patterns of recurrence into broader interpretive frames. This allows us to determine how electoral credibility relates to the chosen topic. For this purpose, we used Braun and Clarke's (2022) approach to thematic analysis and Saldaña's (2021) principles of

coding.

This research applies qualitative standards of rigour through coding notes, categorisation, and memo writing. Reflexivity is another crucial aspect because prior understandings of elections, media, and institutions may shape interpretations of political discourse. As Tracy (2010) claims, the credibility of a qualitative analysis relies on transparency, sincerity, and consistency in the methodological framework and the arguments raised by the researcher. These aspects shape the current analysis and allow frames to emerge from the data rather than being preconceived.

Results

This section presents the key frames that emerged from selected public X posts and replies on the issue of real-time transmission of results in preparation for the 2027 general elections in Nigeria. Public entities, including individuals, media institutions, civic associations, and others, are named as they posted using public accounts. Regular users in the reply thread are represented using codes such as R1, R2, and R3, and so forth. The original posts are represented using codes such as P1, P2, P3, etc.

Table 1: Selected X Posts on Real-Time Result Transmission and Electoral Credibility

Code

Account/Source

URL

Actor Category

Date

Tweet Focus

Dominant Frame

P1

Atiku Abubakar

https://x.com/atiku/status/2019385644535984634

Political actor

February 5, 2026

Senate rejection of real-time electronic transmission of election results

Transparency, safeguard, and Institutional sincerity

P2

Peter Obi

https://x.com/PeterObi/status/2019414618280513851

Political actor

February 5, 2026

Electronic transmission, electoral credibility, and public trust

Transparency, safeguard, and Institutional sincerity

P3

Yunusa Tanko / Obidient Movement

https://x.com/YunusaTanko/status/2019818843422761336

Political movement voice

February 6, 2026

Obidient Movement's rejection of the non-passage of electronic result transmission

Political contest and transparency demand

P4

THISDAY LIVE

https://x.com/THISDAYLIVE/status/2016549361883238913

Media organisation

January 28, 2026

Senate move to mandate real-time electronic transmission of results

Media reporting and reform debate

P5

The Sun

https://x.com/thesunnigeria/status/2019690305025712368

Media organisation

February 6, 2026

Criticism of Senate rejection of automatic real-time result

Transparency, safeguard, and Institutional sincerity

P6

TheCable

https://x.com/thecableng/status/2019876744157925819

Media organisation

February 6, 2026

Obidient Movement's planned march over Senate rejection of real-time result transmission

Political contest and civic mobilisation

P7

Official PDP

https://x.com/OfficialPDPNig/status/2021328436820836402

Political party

February 10, 2026

PDP reaction to Senate position on electronic transmission

Institutional sincerity and political contest

P8

Barristerstreet

https://x.com/Barristerstreet/status/2020904036237488479

Legal and civic commentary

February 9, 2026

Olisa Agbakoba's call for statutory backing of electronic result transmission

Legal reform and credibility safeguard

P9

Nasir El-Rufai

https://x.com/elrufai/status/2020798513093771315

Political elite/commentator

February 9, 2026

Electronic transmission, BVAS, IReV, and electoral integrity

Technical credibility and institutional trust

P10

EiE Nigeria

https://x.com/EiENigeria/status/2019425749762208148

Civic advocacy organisation

February 5, 2026

Call to restore mandatory electronic

Civic accountability and voter education

P11

Nigeria Civil Society Situation Room

https://x.com/SituationRoomNg/status/2021199912256323685

Civic advocacy organisation

February 10, 2026

Senate approval of electronic transmission of results

Civic accountability and vote protection

P12

ARISE NEWS

https://x.com/ARISEtv/status/2023034517628334306

Media organisation

February 15, 2026

Senate approval of amendment allowing electronic transmission with manual backup

Media clarification and technical distinction

P13

INEC Nigeria

https://x.com/inecnigeria/status/2036444224443310460

Electoral institution

March 24, 2026

INEC engagement with political parties on draft 2026 regulations ahead of 2027 elections

Institutional preparedness and procedural trust

P14

INEC Nigeria

https://x.com/inecnigeria/status/2059246341335687663

Electoral institution

May 26, 2026

INEC media engagement and preparation for the 2027 general elections

Institutional readiness and electoral trust

Source: Author's compilation from selected public X posts on real-time result transmission and electoral credibility ahead of Nigeria's 2027 general elections.

Table 2: Reply Thread

Code

Linked to Original Post

Reply Focus

Selected Reply Excerpt

Frame Supported or Challenged

R1

P1

Links real-time transmission to the prevention of result manipulation

"They kept the old discretionary clause... instead of locking in real-time upload to IReV. This preserves the

same loopholes for tampering..."

Transparency and safeguard

R2

P2

Connects electronic transmission to public trust in 2027 elections

"Electronic transmission is no longer a luxury or an experiment; it is a minimum standard for trust, accountability, and electoral peace."

Transparency and safeguard

R3

P7

Questions the sincerity of political actors resisting transmission

"BVAS that will accredit hundreds of people will suddenly not have network to upload an 800kb... result sheet. We must not accept this."

Institutional sincerity

R4

P9

Raises concern about BVAS, IReV, and implementation reliability

"How do you prevent claim of SERVER RESULTS... transmission is not the same as collation?"

Technical and infrastructural risk

R5

P11

Questions whether the network or connectivity failure clause could weaken real-time electronic transmission

"if it fails? They will make sure it fails and resort to manual collation."

Technical risk and procedural suspicion

R6

P12

Questions whether manual backup may weaken electronic transmission

"We said we need it to be made a law MANDATORY... with no option of manual collations."

Technical risk and procedural suspicion

R7

P13

Connects INEC regulations to preparedness for credible elections

"Early engagement with parties can help improve transparency and build trust ahead of 2027."

Institutional preparedness

Source: Author's compilation from selected replies to public X posts on real-time result transmission and electoral credibility ahead of Nigeria's 2027 general elections.

Real-Time Result Transmission as a Transparency Safeguard

This frame presents real-time result transmission as a protection against electoral manipulation, and transparency during voting. From table 1, posts under this frame connected real-time result transmission to transparency, immediate access to results, reduced chances of manipulation, and increased public trust. Atiku Abubakar and Peter Obi linked real-time transmission of results to election transparency and public trust before the 2027 elections (P1; P2). The discussion implies that the issue of real-time transmission of results reflects a lack of trust in the democratic process. EiE Nigeria demanded the mandatory real-time transmission of results to protect votes and ensure accountability in the elections (P10). Situation Room (11) framed real-time transmission of results as a civic accountability and vote protection issue by calling for the conference committee to adopt the house version that included real-time transmission,

The media organisations also propagated the transparency frame. THISDAY LIVE featured the Senate's move to mandate real-time electronic transmission of results (P4), while The Sun Nigeria and The Cable covered public and political reactions to the ongoing Senate debate (P5; P6). Meanwhile, ARISE NEWS covered the Senate's decision on electronic transmission and manual backup, taking the discussion further by explaining how electronic transmission works (P12). In the replies, X users supported the transparency frame by linking electronic transmission to protecting results from manipulation from the polling unit to the collation centre (R1; R2). Additionally, R7 extended this concern by suggesting that the conditional transmission clause could be exploited as a loophole for manual collation.

Real-Time Result Transmission as a Test of Institutional Sincerity

In the second frame, real-time result transmission was seen as a way to assess the sincerity of political/electoral institutions. Posts in this frame focused on the implications of supporting or opposing electronic result transmission for the intentions of political leaders, legislators, and electoral administrators. In this respect, the official People Democratic Party (PDP) in Nigeria interpreted the Senate's stance on electronic result transmission as raising concerns about political commitment to credible elections (P7). Yunusa Tanko, from the standpoint of the Obidient Movement, found the failure to pass legislation on compulsory electronic result transmission unacceptable and called for civic engagement on the matter (P3). Both posts framed electronic transmission not just as a technical issue but also in terms of political trust and the integrity of the 2027 elections.

In addition, this frame included legal and civic discourses. The discourse provided by Barristerstreet in relation to Agbakoba's plea for statutory support for the electronic result transmission showed the significance of legal discourses in building public trust in the electoral process (P8). The replies to the tweets raised doubts about the motives of actors unwilling to back compulsory electronic transmission (R3). The responses suggested that resistance to electronic transmission would indicate a lack of commitment to transparency in the electoral process.

Result transmission as a Technical and Infrastructural Risk

The third frame highlighted the need to disseminate results in real time, but this depended on infrastructure. Accordingly, posts and responses focused on implementation, network access, insecurity, rural connectivity, logistics, and election preparedness. Nasir El-Rufai's post discussed the link between electronic transmission

and the Bi-modal Voter Accreditation System (BVAS), the INEC Result Viewing Portal (IReV), and electoral integrity (P9). In this regard, the post places this issue in the broader context of electronic transmission of results in Nigeria's election management system. ARISE NEWS added to this frame by reporting that the Senate had adopted electronic transmission with manual backup. Thereby raising the question of how the two processes could work together (P12). While some comments raised doubts about the effectiveness and adoption of electronic transmission across the country in terms of internet connectivity, poor infrastructure, or insecurity in particular areas (R4; R6), such comments did not oppose electronic transmission but rather expressed fear of technical failure or lack of universal implementation that would affect the credibility of the process. Similarly, INEC's posts on the draft regulations of 2026 and preparations for the 2027 general elections were framed in the same context, shifting focus to preparedness issues (P13; P14).

Competing Interpretation in the Reply Threads

The fourth frame largely appeared in response threads, where people responded in different ways to posts about the real-time transmission of election results. For instance, some preferred mandatory electronic transmission, while others raised concerns about the political intentions behind the demand, its implementation, and the concept of manual transmission. In posts by Atiku Abubakar, Peter Obi, EiE Nigeria, and Official PDP Nigeria, some individuals suggested that real-time transmission could help stop result manipulation and build trust among people (R1, R2, R3). The language used here revolved around frames such as transparency, safeguarding of votes, and stopping rigging when collecting results. However, other responses questioned the political nature of the debate, as it seemed that politicians were using the demand for compulsory electronic transmission to mobilise people in preparation for 2027 rather than improve elections (R6; R7).

The third group of responses focused on implementation. In response to posts reporting electronic transmission with manual backup, respondents raised concerns about whether manual backup could interfere with the purpose of real-time electronic transmission (R6). Other responses also raised concerns about network coverage, the reliability of the INEC Result Viewing Portal (IReV), and the Bimodal Voter Accreditation System's (BVAS) ability to implement a uniform process in polling places (R4; R6). Later comments in response to posts from INEC discussed result transmission and other election-preparation issues, such as voter registration, regulations, the voter database, and organizational readiness (P13; P14).

Discussion of Findings

The research results address the study's two objectives by showing how specific X posts and replies shaped the framing of real-time result transmission before Nigeria's 2027 general elections. They also show how this framing influenced perceptions of electoral credibility and transparency. The study identified four major frames: transparency as a shield, institutional sincerity, technical and infrastructural threat, and differing perceptions in replies. The study regarded real-time result transmission as an indicator of institutional trust, political sincerity, technological preparedness, and electoral credibility.

In the transparency frame, political and civic actors used real-time results transmission to support credible elections. For instance, Atiku Abubakar, Peter Obi, and EiE Nigeria mentioned real-time results transmission in connection with vote safety, verification, and protection from manipulation (P1; P2; P10). Situation Room's emphasis on conditional electronic transmission shows that public concern was on the procedure containing loopholes that could return the process to manual collation. This supports the first research objective by showing how selected X posts use real-time results transmission to ensure transparency and safeguard election integrity. This aligns with framing theory, since framing clarifies what is at stake by emphasising specific elements of the issue at hand (Entman, 1996). In the selected posts, the main concern was not just about moving results from one place to another. Instead, electronic transmission was seen as proof that the electoral

process could be open, traceable, and less likely to be tampered with. This shows that electoral trust depends not only on formal institutions but also on how citizens and political actors see the fairness and openness of election procedures (Amakoh, 2025; Mauk & Grömping, 2024).

The technical and infrastructural risk paradigm challenges the idea that technology necessarily leads to trust in the election process. The messages regarding the BVAS, IReV, manual contingency, network problems, and INEC preparations indicate that, apart from the concerns related to the necessity for electronic result transmission, the concerns were related to the ability to implement it successfully across all polling stations (P9; P12; P13; P14; R4; R5). This addresses the second research objective by showing that public trust in elections is affected not only by support but also by fears about the effectiveness of technological measures. Network problems, unclear procedures, and inconsistent implementation create mistrust. This aligns with literature arguing that although digital political communication makes democracy visible, it also makes it ambiguous and open to multiple interpretations (Naranjo-Vinueza et al., 2025; Stremlau, 2025).

The discussion threads reveal that X was not just a platform for political communication but also a forum for negotiating meanings. While some participants subscribed to the narrative of transparency and regarded the electronic transmission process as a means of protecting themselves from manipulation (R1; R2), others challenged the reasons for making the results mandatory or raised feasibility and manual-counting issues (R4; R5; R6). This highlights that public discourse on electoral integrity is negotiated and contested. This finding resonates with recent literature on African political communication, where political parties, civil societies, media, politicians, and citizens communicate on the same platforms when discussing elections (Ajaegbu & Ajaegbu, 2024; Fisher et al., 2024).

However, the conflicting views in the reply threads reflect anticipatory distrust. Although some commenters used electronic transmission to demand for electoral transparency, others acted out of partisanship, institutional distrust, or technological failure. As a result, transmission of results became a focus for expectations, doubts and suspicions about the 2027 elections. This is consistent with research on election communication in Nigeria: digital platforms can generate uncertainty through conflicting stories, emotionally charged statements, and distrust of political institutions (Hassan, 2023; Omilusi, 2025; Okorie & Olagunju, 2025).

Overall, the findings indicate that this study achieved its two objectives. The research identified the frames used in some X posts and reply discussions to transmit real-time results, and how these frames shaped Nigerians' views on transparency, institutional trust, technological readiness, and electoral cynicism ahead of the 2027 elections. The study shows that the debate over real-time result transmission is not merely procedural, but ideological.

Conclusion

This study examines the discourse frames surrounding real-time result transmission in selected X posts and threads before Nigeria's 2027 general elections, and how this discourse shapes perceptions of electoral credibility, transparency, and trust. The results show that real-time transmission of results on X has become a significant indicator of election credibility, rather than an election procedure. Specifically, the analysis identified four frames: transparency shield, institutional sincerity, technical and infrastructural risks, and competing interpretations. These frames show that public discussion of the process's technological, institutional, political, and verification aspects shapes trust in the upcoming elections.

Overall, real-time result transmission has become a symbolic indicator of electoral credibility in Nigeria's emerging digital political space. Beyond being an essential part of the election process, it symbolises transparency, institutional sincerity, and the need to verify results. To overcome distrust in electronic result

transmission in Nigeria, it is important to consider features of its communication environment, including distrust in manual collation, inconsistent trust in BVAS and IReV technologies, concerns about network infrastructure, and X-based public expectations. Further research should compare X discourses with discourses on other communication platforms and track how those pre-election frames evolve during and after the 2027 general elections.

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62. Appendix

63. 7